Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-20

Linux

Linux Plumbers Conference videos now available

Source: LWN.net

> Mike Rapoport has announced the release of the video recordings from the 2026 Linux Plumbers Conference (LPC), which was held in Prague from October 5 through October 7. Find the complete set via the YouTube playlist or look for the video links in the schedule . See also LWN's coverage of talks from...

[$] Development statistics for the 7.3 kernel

Source: LWN.net

> Linus Torvalds released the 7.3 kernel, at the end of the usual nine-week development cycle, on October 18. This cycle, abundantly fueled by LLM-assisted contributions, broke just about every record imaginable. As usual, we have compiled some statistics showing how this release, which is expected to...

[$] Cross-crate forward declarations in Rust

Source: LWN.net

> Rust has several ad-hoc mechanisms to allow user code to influence how the standard library executes. For example, custom panic handlers and custom allocators both involve registering functions that core standard library code needs to call. With more similar features planned, Jana Dönszelmann spotte...

Security updates for Monday

Source: LWN.net

> Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (idm:DL1, kernel, libsoup, perl-URI, python3.14-urllib3, and webkit2gtk3), Debian (apache2, cifs-utils, haproxy, jq, kernel, and xen), Fedora (aom, chezmoi, chromium, docker-buildx, freeipa, freerdp, GitPython, httpd, jfrog-cli, kernel, knot, libheif, l...

Red Hat Enterprise Linux is now a native offering on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Organizations running mission-critical workloads face a fundamental challenge: how to take advantage of Oracle Cloud Infrastructure's performance and

> economics without sacrificing the stability, security, and multicloud consistency that enterprise operations demand. Today, that challenge has a clear...

A patch only reduces risk when it runs in production

Source: Red Hat Blog

> The patch was ready in days. It took months to ship. Why?I hear that question in nearly every customer conversation about vulnerability management. The honest answer is rarely “We didn’t know about it.” It’s “We knew, but getting it into production took longer than the exploit window.”That delay, th...

5-minute demo: DevSecOps with Red Hat OpenShift to speed up application delivery

Source: Red Hat Blog

> If you're a platform engineer, you've likely lived this: your team has assembled a toolchain for CI/CD, monitoring, security scanning, GitOps, and networking. Each tool does its specific job well, but over time, you realize you’re spending more hours maintaining the integrations between those tools...

Security

ClickFix Attackers Exploit Siemens Software Center Flaw to Deploy Remote Access Trojan

Source: The Hacker News

> Siemens has addressed a DLL sideloading vulnerability impacting Siemens Software Center that it said has been exploited in ClickFix attacks. The high-severity vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-110936 (CVSS v4 score: 8.4), could allow an attacker to place a specially-crafted DLL in a directory the a...

Ex-OpenAI Engineer Detained in Spy Device Case as Saudi Royal Contacts Emerge

Source: The Hacker News

> A U.S. court on Monday granted the U.S. government's request to detain a former OpenAI engineer accused of planting a recording device in an executive conference room at the company's San Francisco office to allegedly steal sensitive secrets. In a new court filing Sunday, prosecutors revealed that A...

Hackers Use New ROMULUS ClickFix Platform to Deliver LegionLoader and Other Malware

Source: The Hacker News

> Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed details of a ClickFix delivery platform called ROMULUS that's being used to distribute malware such as Legion Loader. According to Forescout Research - Vedere Labs, ROMULUS is akin to a malware delivery service that employs ClickFix-style lures on bogus landi...

Hackers Exploit Plex2Shell Flaws to Install Crypto Miners and Linux Proxy Backdoor

Source: The Hacker News

> Threat actors have begun to exploit a chain of vulnerabilities in Plex Media Server to deploy cryptocurrency miners and reverse proxy software, a day after a proof-of-concept (PoC) went public. According to a researcher who goes by the online alias boredhackerblog, the exploitation activity involves...

Popular WordPress SEO Plugin Rank Math PRO Hijacked to Deliver Self-Restoring Backdoor

Source: The Hacker News

> Copies of Rank Math PRO, the paid version of the Rank Math SEO plugin for WordPress, that were downloaded from rankmath.com or delivered as updates between 20:02 UTC on October 15 and 07:12 UTC on October 16 contained malware, Rank Math said in a security notice published on October 16. Any site tha...

Weekly Recap: 98 Zero-Days, Rogue AI Agents, $100M Crypto Theft, 700 Supermarkets Hit and More

Source: The Hacker News

> The worst problems don't always come with a warning. Sometimes they arrive through a service everyone trusts, a device someone bought, or a system nobody thought to check. By the time something looks wrong, the damage may already be done. This week had plenty of that. Trusted connections became a pr...

GhostAction Attackers Plant Credential Stealer Disguised as Font in 94 GitHub Repositories

Source: The Hacker News

> The threat actor behind the GhostAction supply chain attack has expanded beyond injecting malicious GitHub Actions workflows into compromised projects to phish open-source developers and deliver a stealer malware disguised within a fake font file. The latest evolution, detailed by OpenSourceMalware,...

From Email-to-Case to the Boardroom: How Inherited Agents Break Governance Built for Software

Source: The Hacker News

> In Salesforce Agentforce, the recommended way to make an agent respond to events is a Flow: a record is created or a case is updated, and the Flow passes data into the agent's prompt. Separately, Email-to-Case and Web-to-Case turn inbound customer messages into case records; it is how airlines and h...

Fake Web3 Accelerator Uses npm Packages to Spread Malware and Hijack AI Agent Traffic

Source: The Hacker News

> A fake Web3 accelerator has been observed pushing information stealers and backdoors to Windows and macOS systems using malicious npm packages under the pretext of offering free artificial intelligence (AI) credits for Anthropic Claude and Google Gemini, coding tools, and security audits. "The tools...

General Tech

UK Defence Startups Are Being Denied Banking Services Under ESG Rules

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://foxandlion.pub/analysis/uk-defence-start-ups-are-being-denied-banking-services-under-esg-rules Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50163462 Points: 6 # Comments: 0

Fizzpoker – No-login Online Poker with friends

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.fizzpoker.com Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50163173 Points: 5 # Comments: 4

There is no official XScreenSaver GitHub repository

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/xscreensaver-official/xscreensaver Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50163142 Points: 4 # Comments: 0

MicroG: Free-libre re-implementation of Google's proprietary Android user space

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/microg/GmsCore/wiki Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50162177 Points: 31 # Comments: 2

Show HN: Death Plan Switch, a self-hosted dead man's switch for solo devs

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Hi HN, I'm Peter Bishop and I've been working in graphics and web tech for over 25yrs. I've recently launched Death Plan Switch to solve a major problem in my succession plan. What if I go missing or die? The right people are told and my business can continue to operate for my clients. There's a bac...

Go will reject certificate chains containing eight distrusted SPKIs

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/golang/go/issues/82345 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50160877 Points: 97 # Comments: 35

OpenBSD 8.0

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.openbsd.org/80.html Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50160494 Points: 293 # Comments: 87

France's supermarket fridges were vulnerable online for months

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Related: Hackers activate automatic defrosting in supermarket fridges across Europe - https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50055304 - Oct 2026 (1007 comments) Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50159616 Points: 170 # Comments: 152

WhatsApp's help pages hid LLM instructions: dont recommend a regulator

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://redact.dev/blog/whatsapp-help-pages-hidden-ai-instructions Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50159341 Points: 434 # Comments: 123

How abliterated models can get you pwned

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://projectdiscovery.io/research/how-abliterated-models-can-get-you-pwned Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50159245 Points: 128 # Comments: 75

An ad-free Android TV

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://cretezy.com/2026/ad-free-android-tv Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50158942 Points: 213 # Comments: 66

OpenBSD 8.0 release will have inteldrm/radeondrm/amdgpu drivers from Linux 6.18

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://bsd.network/@brynet/117407035545900963 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50158138 Points: 155 # Comments: 34

Putting Linux on my RTX Spark laptop because I don't have a Microsoft account

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://josie.lol/blog/linux-rtx-spark Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50158100 Points: 235 # Comments: 120

One Hash Bloom Filters

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://calabro.io/ohbf Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50157865 Points: 102 # Comments: 11

Evidence (YC S21) Is Hiring Software Engineers

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://evidence.dev/jobs Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50155172 Points: 0 # Comments: 0

MiniMax M3.1 Flash

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.minimax.io/blog/minimax-m31f Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50154540 Points: 465 # Comments: 198

DeepSeek banned from U.S. federal civilian agencies under new DHS order

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> https://public-inspection.federalregister.gov/2026-21447.pdf Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50154244 Points: 248 # Comments: 209

Ukraine claims first drone evacuation of wounded soldier

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/world/ukraine/ukraine-first-drone-evacuation-wounded-soldier-frontlines-hexacopter-rcna604310 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50153664 Points: 290 # Comments: 218

Why Is Speculative Decoding Fast?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://jbarrow.ai/2026-10-08-why-is-speculative-decoding-fast/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50152539 Points: 3 # Comments: 0

Maxwell: A new kind of model that sits between code and hardware

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Hi HN, I'm Gal from doubleAI. We've built Maxwell, a new kind of frontier model we call a Code Execution Model. It sits between your code and the hardware. No humans in the loop! Maxwell makes the code run faster as it runs, without ever changing a single line. Maxwell sees programs from the inside:...